

Interview Self Checklist

Investment Banking Technical Curriculum. Run through this the day before your interview. Tick a box only when you can do it without notes.

Technical Mastery (can you do each cold?)

- ☐ Walk through a DCF in under two minutes
- ☐ Explain WACC and compute the cost of equity via CAPM
- ☐ Walk through a basic LBO and name the return drivers
- ☐ Explain how the three financial statements link
- ☐ Walk \$10 of depreciation through all three statements
- ☐ Explain equity value vs enterprise value and the bridge between them
- ☐ Run comparable companies and precedent transactions at a high level
- ☐ Rank the valuation methods and justify the order
- ☐ Explain unlevered vs levered FCF and the matching discount rate
- ☐ Calculate terminal value two ways (Gordon growth and exit multiple)

Behavioral Readiness

- ☐ Deliver your resume walk in under 90 seconds
- ☐ Answer why investment banking without cliches
- ☐ Answer why this firm with specifics, not flattery
- ☐ Have two strong stories for each of leadership, teamwork, failure, and drive
- ☐ State your strengths and weaknesses with real examples
- ☐ Answer why us and not a named competitor
- ☐ Prepare your why-this-group answer for the product or industry

Firm and Role Research

- ☐ Know two or three recent deals the firm advised on
- ☐ Know the group's product or sector focus
- ☐ Have notes from everyone you spoke with at the firm
- ☐ Have three thoughtful questions ready for each interviewer
- ☐ Know the firm's recent news or league-table position

Materials and Logistics

- ☐ Printed copies of your resume for an in-person interview

- ☐ Date, time, and time zone confirmed
- ☐ Location scouted, or the video link tested in advance
- ☐ Professional attire ready the night before
- ☐ Notepad, pen, and water on the desk
- ☐ Phone silenced and notifications off

Final Mindset

- ☐ Listen fully before you answer
- ☐ Structure answers out loud and lead with the point
- ☐ Ask clarifying questions on technicals before solving
- ☐ Stay calm on follow-ups; being pushed is normal
- ☐ Bring energy and genuine interest